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Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

PRESIDENT EXCHANGES EID GREETING WITH RULERS OF EMIRATES

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan receives at Al Mushrif Palace in Abu Dhabi His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, and Their Highnesses Supreme Council Members and Rulers of the Emirates, Dr Shaikh Sultan Bin Mohammad Al Qasimi of Sharjah, Shaikh Humaid Bin Rashid Al Nuaimi of Ajman, Shaikh Hamad Bin Mohammad Al Sharqi of Fujairah, Shaikh Saud Bin Rashid Al Mualla of Umm Al Quwain and Shaikh Saud Bin Saqr Al Qasimi of Ras Al Khaimah, on the occasion of Eid Al Fitr yesterday.

SEE ALSO P5

Aftershocks rattle Myanmar as death toll climbs

1,700 people feared killed so far; at least 17 dead in Thailand

BANGKOK

Residents scrambled desperately through collapsed buildings yesterday searching for survivors as aftershocks rattled the devastated city of Mandalay, two

days after a massive earthquake killed more than 1,700 people in Myanmar and at least 17 in neighbouring Thailand.

The initial 7.7-magnitude quake struck near the central Myanmar city of Mandalay early Friday afternoon, followed minutes later by a 6.7-magnitude aftershock.

The tremors collapsed buildings, downed bridges and buckled roads, with mass de-

struction seen in the city of more than 1.7 million people.

Little chance of survivors

As dawn broke yesterday, tea shop owner Win Lwin picked his way through the remains of a collapsed restaurant on a main road in his neighbourhood, tossing bricks aside one by one.

"About seven people died here" when the quake struck

Friday, he told AFP. "I'm looking for more bodies but I know there cannot be any survivors.

"We don't know how many bodies there could be but we are looking."

About an hour later, a small aftershock struck, sending people scurrying out of a hotel for safety, following a similar tremor felt late Saturday evening.

— AFP

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Syrian President names first woman in new government

UAE LEADERS CONGRATULATE AL SHARAA ON FORMING CABINET

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has sent a cable of congratulations to President Ahmad Al Sharaa of Syria on the occasion of the formation of a new government.

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, and Shaikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court, also dispatched similar congratulatory messages to President Al Sharaa.

Christian woman minister

Al Sharaa on Saturday announced a new transitional government dominated by close allies and including one woman, replacing caretaker authorities in place since the ouster of longtime ruler Bashar Al Assad.

Veteran opposition figure

Hind Kabawat, a member of Syria's Christian minority and longtime Assad opponent, was named social affairs and labour minister, the first woman to be appointed by Sharaa.

The announcement, initially scheduled for earlier this month, comes amid international calls for an inclusive Syrian transition following recent sectarian bloodshed, as the country's new leaders seek to reunite and rebuild Syria and its institutions after Assad's December 8 overthrow brought an end to 14 years of civil war.

Close associates of Sharaa held on to key positions, with Foreign Minister Assaad Al Shaibani and Defence Minister Murhaf Abu Qasra retaining their cabinet posts, while Anas Khattab, the head of general intelligence, was appointed interior minister.

Raed Al Saleh, leader of the White Helmets, the Syrian rescuers who worked in rebel-held areas, was appointed minister of emergency situations and disasters.

— Agencies

PROPERTY

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Eid Mubarak

May the sacredness of this blessed occasion bring joy, peace and prosperity to you and your family.

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